

To send large files that take a long time to download may not respect the other person's time; the files may not reflect their sense of humour or point of view, and may even max out their e-mail box. This is being inconsiderate and lazy.

E-mail Woes

Unfortunately, the advancement of technology has its negatives. It is now possible to get a virus without even opening an e-mail—that started with W32.Nimda.A@mm (or simply, Nimda) in September 2001, which merely required you click on the subject of the e-mail in your mail program (or in some mail clients, have the preview pane on).

Several of the latest viruses actually use e-mail addresses farmed out of your address book or inbox to send the virus and propagate itself to all those listed, with your name in the 'From' field. The latest viruses can send themselves out with your friend's names in the 'From' field, or any combination of e-mail addresses found on your system!

The need for a 24/7 real-time virus protection software is no longer a choice—it is your responsibility to remain virus-free. You will also need to update your virus files regularly. Check for updates every time you log on so that your computer is protected using the latest virus definitions.

The Basics Of Virus Protection

- m Get an active program that is always 'On'. This will catch any viruses as they are being downloaded, so they can immediately be quarantined and cannot infect your system.
- m Update your virus definitions daily, or every time you log on. These updates can be downloaded from the Web site of your virus software manufacturer. Most have a scheduler to tell your computer to do this automatically.